



GRETCHEN WHITMER
GOVERNOR

STATE OF MICHIGAN
DEPARTMENT OF
ENVIRONMENT, GREAT LAKES, AND ENERGY
AIR QUALITY DIVISION



PHILLIP D. ROOS
DIRECTOR

June 30, 2026

VIA EMAIL

Marisol Carrera, Plant QHSE Manager
Novares - Howell
1301 McPherson Park Drive
Howell, Michigan 48843

SRN: N2148, Livingston County

Dear Marisol Carrera:

PERFORMANCE TESTING REQUIRED

On April 7, 2026, the Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy (EGLE), Air Quality Division (AQD) sent a violation notice (VN) to Novares - Howell (Company) located at 1301 McPherson Park Drive, Howell, Michigan. The AQD requested documentation of any past testing of VOC capture efficiency and VOC destruction efficiency, to show compliance with Special Condition (SC) 1.8 of Permit to Install (PTI) No. 275-02 v1.0.

SC 1.8 of PTI 275-02 v1.0 requires a minimum VOC capture efficiency of 90 percent (by weight) and a minimum VOC destruction efficiency of 95 percent (by weight). Verification of the capture and destruction efficiencies are also required to show compliance with the emission limits in the permit, including SC 1.1a, 1.1b, 2.1a, 2.1b, and 2.1c.

The company responded to the VN on April 28, 2026. In the Company's response to the VN, no records or documentation of prior stack testing were provided.

The AQD is now formally requesting performance testing to determine the VOC emission rate, the VOC capture efficiency of the control equipment, and the VOC destruction efficiency of the control equipment while the paint line is operating under routine maximum conditions. This testing must be completed by no later than **August 28, 2026**. Please note that conducting a capture test to demonstrate 90% capture can present challenges. We recommend we set up a meeting to discuss the possible alternatives to this type of test.

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Authority:

Under Part 10 of the Air Pollution Control Rules, Rule 1001(1)(c) (R 336.2001) specifies:

Rule 1001.

(1) The department may require the owner or operator of a source of air contaminant to conduct acceptable performance tests, at the owner's or operator's expense, in accordance with R 336.2003 under any of the following conditions: [...]

(c) The owner or operator of the source has not submitted an acceptable performance test, in accordance with R 336.2003, that demonstrates that the source complies with either the department's rules or the conditions specified in the permit to install, or both.

Furthermore, Rule 1001 requires the following:

(2) Performance tests required by subrule (1) of this rule must be conducted within 60 days following receipt of written notification from the department, unless otherwise authorized by the department.

(3) Not less than 30 days before a performance test, as required by subrule (1) of this rule, the owner or operator, or an authorized agent, shall do both of the following:

(a) Submit a site-specific test plan for approval by the department. The plan must include a test program summary, test schedule, and the quality assurance measures to be applied.

(b) Notify the department, in writing, of the time and place of the performance tests and who shall conduct them as provided in the site-specific test plan required under subdivision (a) of this subrule. A representative of the department shall have the opportunity to witness these tests.

(4) Results of performance tests must be submitted to the department in the format prescribed by the applicable reference test method within 60 days after the last date of the test.

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Timeline:

Action / Deliverable	Date / Due Date	Rule Citation
Date of this Letter	June 30, 2026	R 336.2001(1)(c)
Performance tests to determine the VOC emission rate, and the VOC capture efficiency of the control equipment, and the VOC destruction efficiency of the control equipment must be conducted.	By no later than August 28, 2026	R 336.2001(2)
Submit a site-specific test plan for approval by the department. The plan must include a test program summary, test schedule, and the quality assurance measures to be applied; and notify the department, in writing, of the time and place of the performance tests and who shall conduct them as provided in the site-specific test plan. A representative of the department shall have the opportunity to witness these tests.	Not less than 30 days before the scheduled performance test.	R 336.2001(3)
Results of performance tests must be submitted to the department in the format prescribed by the applicable reference test method within 60 days after the last date of the test.	Within 60 days after the last date of the test.	R 336.2001(4)

Next Steps:

Responses should be submitted through [MiEnviro Portal](#) using the following appropriate schedules listed under Dashboard – As Needed:

- Test Plan: use schedule “Air Quality Test Plan Submittal”
- Notification of time and place of performance tests and who shall conduct them: “Air General Compliance Report”
- Results of performance tests: “Air Quality Test Report Submittal”

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Thank you for your attention and cooperation. If you have any questions regarding the testing, please contact me at the number listed below, or Robert Byrnes at 517-275-0439 or ByrnesR@michigan.gov.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Michelle Rogers". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Michelle" and last name "Rogers" clearly distinguishable.

Michelle Rogers
Senior Environmental Engineer
Air Quality Division
810-304-4755
RogersM13@michigan.gov

cc: Brad Myott, EGLE
Robert Byrnes, EGLE